



Center for International Mediators & Arbitrators

JOIN A GROWING COMMUNITY OF INNOVATIVE DISPUTE RESOLUTION PROFESSIONALS

We are building a dynamic global network
Be part of a something mighty



Center for International Mediators and Arbitrators (CIMA)
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Francesco Campagna

President, CIMA

I am proud of CIMA's growing influence and commitment to promoting alternative dispute resolution across diverse regions. In the past year, we have focused on fostering greater inclusivity within the ADR community, creating opportunities for practitioners from emerging regions to access world-class education and professional development. CIMA's initiatives in Africa and the Middle East reflect our dedication to the highest standards of professionalism and cultural sensitivity.

Our launch of region-specific programs and scholarships has been a game-changer, enabling us to support the unique needs of our members in Africa and the Middle East. Our acronym MIGHTY stand for: Mediation, International Arbitration, Global Hub of Training and Youth Empowerment.

This represents CIMA's dedication to Mediation and Arbitration, fostering Innovation in dispute resolution, advancing Global Harmonization of ADR standards, providing world-class Training, and engaging Youth to inspire the next generation of ADR professionals. It embodies strength, ambition, and inclusivity.

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About CIMA

Center for International Mediators
and Arbitrators

The Center for International Mediators and Arbitrators (CIMA) was established to meet the demand for specialized training and certification in the realms of international mediation and arbitration. As a non-profit institution, CIMA is dedicated to advancing alternative dispute resolution by providing rigorous education and professional accreditation to practitioners across the globe. With a particular focus on nurturing ADR talent in emerging regions such as Africa, Asia, and the Middle East, CIMA aspires to enrich the global discourse on dispute resolution through diverse perspectives. Its programs encompass simulations, mock sessions, and interactive exercises that sharpen practical skills, thereby equipping professionals to excel within an increasingly interconnected legal landscape.

CIMA upholds the highest standards in ADR, collaborating extensively with both local and international bodies to foster a community of distinguished practitioners, academics, and judicial figures. Through a range of conferences, seminars, and advanced training modules, CIMA promotes the continual exchange of knowledge and best practices, while also recognizing individuals who contribute outstandingly to the field. With offices in London, Accra and Dubai, CIMA is a leading institution in ADR, forging a path for excellence in mediation and arbitration that serves the diverse needs of contemporary dispute resolution community.



1. Introduction

2. Advancing Global Standards in Dispute Resolution

- Education and Training
- Competence Frameworks

3. Promoting Mediation, Adjudication and Arbitration across Africa

- Thought Leadership and Advocacy

4. Supporting a Diverse Community of Dispute Resolvers

- Volunteer Strategy
- Equality, Diversity, and Inclusion
- Regional Strategy

5. Operational Support and Infrastructure

- Data and Insight
- Technology Development
- Governance and Compliance

6. Achievements in 2024

7. Financial Summary and Future Goals

8. Our Courses: Beginner, Intermediate and Fellowship

This Annual Plan outlines CIMA's goals and initiatives for 2025 to serve the Africa region and contribute to the advancement of mediation, adjudication and arbitration globally. Founded to address the specific needs of mediators and arbitrators within Africa and internationally, CIMA is committed to fostering a collaborative, inclusive, and supportive environment for practitioners.

OUR MISSION IS TO:

- Promote and facilitate alternative dispute resolution (ADR) worldwide.
- Provide high-quality education and training for dispute resolution professionals.
- Develop a global community of dispute resolution experts with diverse perspectives and experiences.

CIMA prioritizes accessible and effective training to enhance the skills of dispute resolution practitioners. In 2025, we will:

- Maintain high standards in training delivery across all CIMA courses.
- Launch specialized courses in international arbitration, mediation, and adjudication.
- Pilot differentiated pricing structures for regions to ensure inclusivity.
- Introduce a digital Learning Management System to enhance online learning.

COMPETENCE FRAMEWORKS

CIMA's Competence Frameworks define global standards in dispute resolution. In 2025, we will:

- Finalize a curriculum based on core competencies in mediation, adjudication and arbitration.
- Develop faculty training programs and high tech-support for quality education.
- Begin a review of pathways for experienced practitioners to enter CIMA Fellowship.

THOUGHT LEADERSHIP AND ADVOCACY

As a leading body in ADR, CIMA aims to promote best practices and influence global standards.

In 2025, we will:

- Publish guidelines on AI in arbitration, third-party funding, and climate disputes.
- Strengthen relationships with key institutions to enhance CIMA's influence globally.
- Participate in international forums such as ICCA and co-host events to increase awareness of ADR

CIMA relies on dedicated volunteers for its initiatives.

In 2024, we will:

- Streamline volunteer processes to reduce administrative burdens.
- Acknowledge volunteers consistently, ensuring rewarding experiences.

EQUALITY, DIVERSITY AND INCLUSION

CIMA champions diversity in ADR.

In 2025, we will:

- Integrate EDI principles in event planning, training, and content creation.
- Develop data to support long-term EDI goals and evaluate our impact.

REGIONAL STRATEGY

To expand its global presence, CIMA will focus on:

- Collaborating with regional organizations to deliver value in local markets.
- Enhancing communication and support for regional chapters.

DATA AND INSIGHT

Data-driven decisions are key to CIMA's growth.

In 2025, we will:

- Refresh member insights through surveys to understand member needs.
- Analyze data for strategic planning and continuous improvement

TECHNOLOGY DEVELOPMENT

CIMA is committed to leveraging technology to improve member experience.

In 2025, we will:

- Deploy a new website and member portal for seamless information access.
- Implement a CRM system to manage relationships with members, volunteers, and partners.

GOVERNANCE AND COMPLIANCE

To uphold high standards, CIMA will focus on:

- Strengthening compliance with legal and data protection standards.
- Developing risk management processes in collaboration with an Audit Committee.



2023 marked several milestones for CIMA.

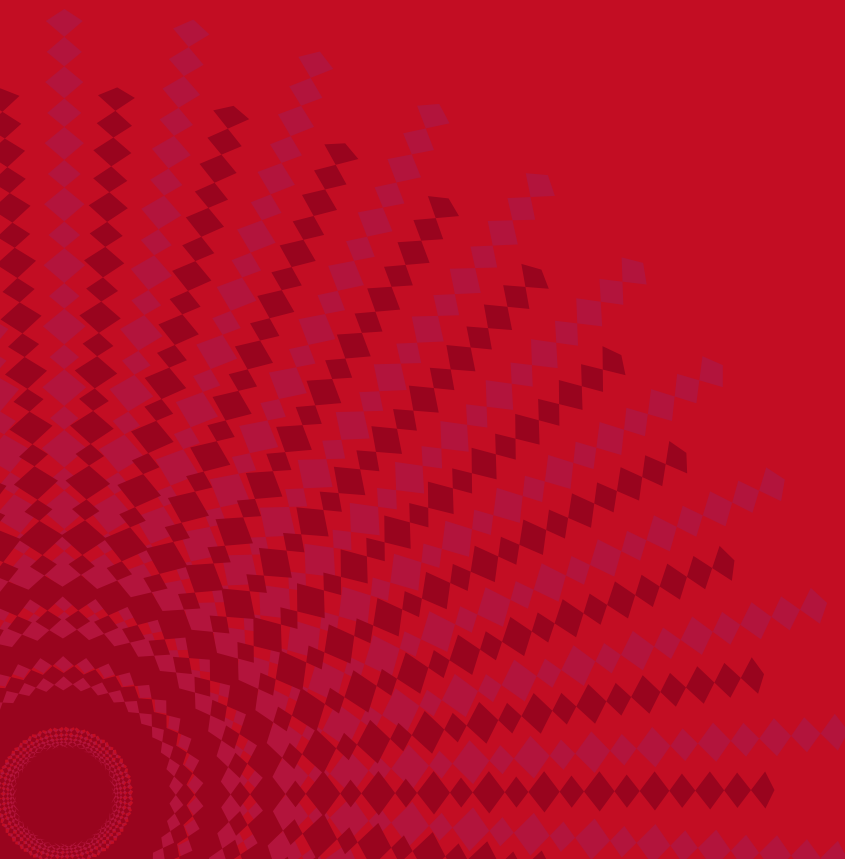
Key achievements included:

- Launching CIMA's first training programs in mediation and arbitration, drawing participants from multiple countries.
- Hosting successful international webinars on dispute resolution and securing partnerships with African and international organizations.
- Establishing thought leadership groups focused on emerging issues like digital transformation in ADR and the role of AI in arbitration.

Our Professional Programmes

We encourage you to take CIMA's Beginner Level course in "Foundations of International Mediation and Arbitration" and progress to our Intermediate Level course in "Advanced Principles and Practices in Arbitration and Mediation."

These courses are designed to support professional development at different stages of expertise, providing both foundational knowledge and advanced skills.





Course Title: Foundations of International Mediation and Arbitration

Overview: This course is tailored for professionals who are new to alternative dispute resolution (ADR) and wish to gain foundational knowledge in international mediation and arbitration. It is ideal for junior lawyers, corporate professionals, recent graduates, and individuals exploring careers in ADR.

COURSE OBJECTIVES:

- Introduce participants to the basic principles, history, and framework of international mediation and arbitration.
- Familiarize participants with the types, structures, and roles involved in ADR.
- Build essential skills in case preparation, communication, and mediation strategies.

Assessment: Participants will complete a short multiple-choice quiz and a practical exercise that simulates a simple mediation or arbitration scenario. Successful participants will receive a Certificate of Completion in Foundations of International Mediation and Arbitration.

Duration: 8 weeks (self-paced online modules with weekly live tutorials).



COURSE MODULES:

1. Introduction to ADR and Its Importance

- Understanding Alternative Dispute Resolution (ADR): definitions and key concepts.
- History and evolution of ADR practices.
- The role and significance of ADR in global commerce and cross-border disputes.

2. Types of ADR: Mediation vs. Arbitration

- Overview of different ADR methods (mediation, arbitration, negotiation, conciliation).
- Key differences between mediation and arbitration.
- Selecting the appropriate ADR method for different types of disputes.

3. Fundamental Principles of Mediation and Arbitration

- Key principles: confidentiality, neutrality, and voluntary participation.
- Overview of the UNCITRAL Model Law and New York Convention.
- Basic rules and procedural requirements in arbitration.

4. Roles and Responsibilities in ADR

- The role of the mediator, arbitrator, and parties in the ADR process.
- Ethical responsibilities of ADR practitioners.
- Introduction to impartiality, independence, and conflict of interest.

5. Basic Communication and Negotiation Skills

- Building trust and rapport with parties.
- Active listening, questioning techniques, and effective communication.
- Introduction to negotiation strategies in mediation.

6. Introduction to Case Preparation and Documentation

- Overview of the case preparation process in mediation and arbitration.
- Understanding arbitration agreements and mediation clauses.
- Basics of gathering and presenting evidence.



Course Title: Advanced Principles and Practices in Arbitration and Mediation

Overview: This course is intended for professionals with some experience or foundational knowledge in ADR who seek to deepen their understanding and develop practical skills in managing arbitration and mediation cases. Ideal participants include junior to mid-level practitioners, in-house counsel, and professionals with initial ADR training.

COURSE OBJECTIVES:

- Explore advanced concepts in ADR and their application to real-world cases.
- Develop competencies in case management, procedural strategies, and award writing.
- Build skills in managing complex mediation scenarios and enforcing arbitral awards.

Assessment: Participants will be evaluated through a combination of a written exam, case study analysis, and a simulated arbitration exercise in which they draft an award. Upon successful completion, participants will receive a Certificate of Completion in Advanced Principles and Practices in Arbitration and Mediation.

Duration: 12 weeks (blended learning with online modules, live tutorials, and interactive sessions).



COURSE MODULES:

1. Advanced Legal Frameworks in International Arbitration

- Detailed exploration of the UNCITRAL Model Law, New York Convention, and regional arbitration laws.
- Understanding arbitral jurisdiction, tribunal powers, and the enforceability of awards.
- Analysis of key cases and precedents impacting ADR practice.

2. Drafting and Analyzing Arbitration Agreements

- Essentials of drafting enforceable arbitration agreements.
- Key clauses, seat of arbitration, and choice of law considerations.
- Modifying and analyzing arbitration agreements to fit complex cases.

3. Managing Complex Mediation Cases

- Strategies for handling multi-party mediations and high-stakes disputes.
- Managing power dynamics, high emotions, and entrenched positions.
- Techniques for facilitating collaborative problem-solving in difficult mediations.

4. Procedural Management in Arbitration

- Detailed procedural requirements: from initial filings to evidence gathering.
- Effective case management and document disclosure.
- Dealing with procedural challenges, interim measures, and emergency arbitration.

5. Award Writing and Enforceability

- Key components of a legally enforceable arbitral award.
- Writing clear, logical, and defensible awards.
- Reviewing grounds for setting aside awards and avoiding common pitfalls.

6. Ethical Considerations and Best Practices

- Ethical dilemmas in arbitration and mediation: maintaining neutrality, avoiding bias.
- Confidentiality obligations and data protection in ADR.
- Professional standards and codes of conduct for mediators and arbitrators.

Additional Features for Both Courses

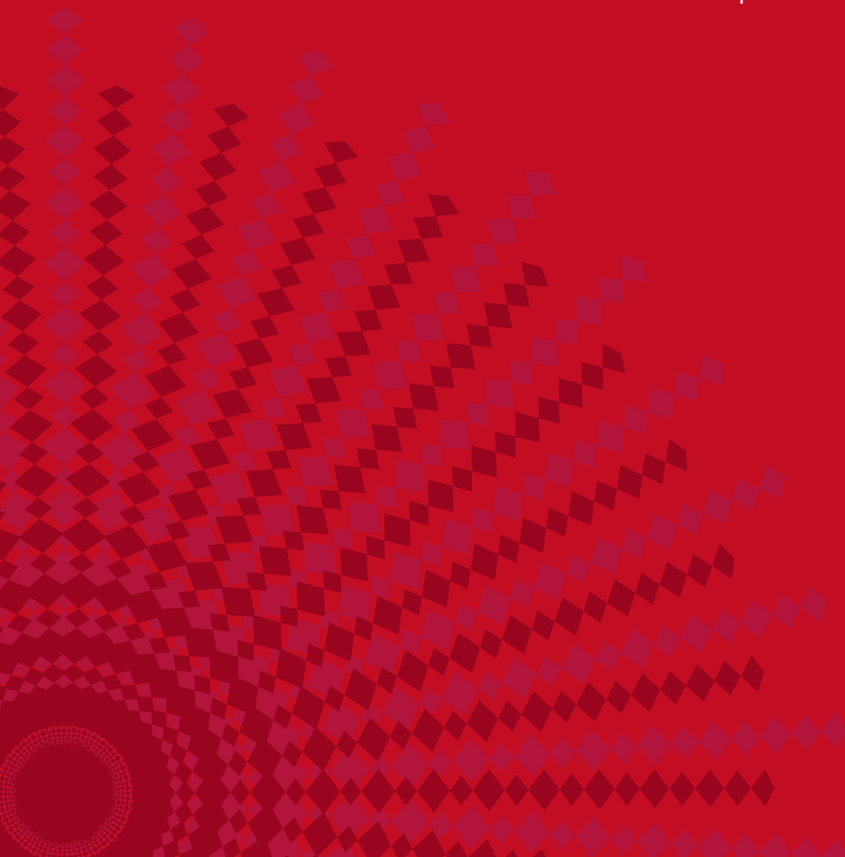
- **Live Tutorials and Q&A Sessions:** Weekly live sessions where instructors address questions and provide case-specific insights.
- **Networking Opportunities:** Access to CIMA's network of practitioners for building professional connections and mentorship.
- **Digital Resource Library:** Access to materials, case studies, and resources that supplement the course content and enhance understanding.

These courses lay a solid foundation and develop advanced skills in ADR, enabling participants to gain recognition and professional development within the CIMA community and the broader ADR landscape.

CIMA World Fellows Program

The CIMA World Fellows Program in International Arbitration

The CIMA World Fellowship in International Arbitration is a prestigious program designed to establish a benchmark of excellence in arbitration, rigorously preparing participants to meet the complexities of modern dispute resolution. This comprehensive program is ideal for legal practitioners, corporate counsel, judges, and experienced arbitrators aiming to refine their skills and expand their expertise in international arbitration. Combining theoretical insights with practical experience, the Fellowship equips participants to handle high-stakes, cross-border disputes with professionalism and competence, setting them apart as leaders in the field.



The CIMA World Fellowship is structured over six months, offering a balanced blend of flexible online learning modules, live tutorials, and case-based assessments. The program's hybrid structure allows professionals to continue their careers while undertaking specialized study, making it accessible for individuals worldwide. Delivered by a distinguished faculty of international arbitration experts, the Fellowship offers an immersive experience in arbitration principles, strategic case management, and complex legal frameworks. The curriculum aligns with the UNCITRAL Model Law, New York Convention, and other prominent legal instruments, ensuring that participants gain a solid foundation in international standards and best practices.

PROGRAM OBJECTIVES

The primary objectives of the CIMA World Fellowship are to:

- Equip participants with a thorough understanding of international arbitration frameworks, rules, and laws.
- Develop advanced skills in managing and resolving complex arbitration cases.
- Instil ethical standards and professional conduct essential for effective arbitration.
- Enhance practical competencies through simulations, case studies, and mentorship.

Each module within the Fellowship is designed to address specific aspects of international arbitration, ensuring a well-rounded and practical education.

1. Foundations of International Arbitration

- Understand the historical evolution of arbitration as an alternative dispute resolution mechanism.
- Explore the core principles, processes, and rules governing arbitration on a global scale, including the UNCITRAL Model Law and the New York Convention.
- Compare institutional arbitration (e.g., ICC, LCIA) with ad hoc arbitration, understanding when and how each is applied.

2. Legal Framework and Procedural Aspects

- Examine the scope and enforceability of arbitration agreements, including jurisdiction, arbitrability, and the law governing arbitration.
- Understand the authority, responsibilities, and ethical duties of arbitrators under various jurisdictions.
- Learn the procedural rules for initiating and managing arbitration, including pleadings, document disclosure, and evidentiary standards.

3. Complex Issues in Arbitration

- Navigate multi-party arbitration and the challenges it poses, including joinder and consolidation of parties.
- Study recognition and enforcement of arbitral awards in different jurisdictions, focusing on obstacles like public policy exceptions.
- Address the unique complexities of investment arbitration and disputes involving state-owned entities, including sovereign immunity.

4. Ethics and Professional Standards

- Gain insights into the ethical principles and codes of conduct that govern arbitrators, including impartiality, disclosure, and confidentiality.
- Study the role of state courts in supporting or intervening in arbitration, understanding judicial discretion and review standards.
- Address challenges around conflicts of interest, including best practices for ensuring neutrality and independence.

5. Skills Development and Practical Application

- Develop proficiency in drafting enforceable arbitration agreements tailored to specific disputes and jurisdictions.
- Refine procedural skills in case management, witness examination, and evidence handling.
- Participate in mock arbitration simulations to apply theoretical knowledge in realistic scenarios, building confidence in arbitration practice.
- Learn the art of decision-writing and award drafting, ensuring clarity, consistency, and compliance with enforceability standards.

MENTORSHIP PROGRAM

Each participant will be paired with an experienced arbitration mentor from CIMA's global network, offering guidance on career development, professional ethics, and practical challenges in arbitration. This mentorship fosters a deeper connection to the international arbitration community and provides valuable networking opportunities.

INTERACTIVE WEBINARS AND MASTERCLASSES

In addition to core modules, participants have access to exclusive webinars and masterclasses led by renowned arbitration practitioners, covering topics like emerging technologies in arbitration, sector-specific arbitration (e.g., construction, maritime, energy), and the impact of artificial intelligence on ADR.

GLOBAL NETWORKING OPPORTUNITIES

Fellows gain access to CIMA's global alumni network, allowing for ongoing professional development, collaboration, and engagement with leaders in arbitration across jurisdictions. Networking events include annual conferences, seminars, and special interest groups that foster cross-border connections and knowledge exchange.

CIMA promotes the Willem C. Vis Moot by mentoring African teams, hosting workshops, and enhancing Africa's presence in international arbitration, fostering global excellence.



The program culminates in a rigorous assessment process designed to evaluate both theoretical knowledge and practical application. Assessments include:

- **Written Examination:** Tests understanding of key principles, legal frameworks, and procedural issues in international arbitration.
- **Case Study and Presentation:** Participants prepare and present a case analysis, demonstrating strategic and analytical skills.
- **Mock Arbitration Assessment:** Fellows will participate in a simulated arbitration exercise, evaluated on their ability to manage a proceeding, interact with parties, and render an award.

Upon successful completion of the program, participants will be awarded the **CIMA Global Fellow in International Arbitration** designation, a credential recognized worldwide as a symbol of excellence and expertise in dispute resolution. Fellows are entitled to use the “FCIMA” post-nominal, marking them as distinguished members of the international arbitration community.

The Fellowship is open to:

- Experienced legal practitioners with a minimum of five years of professional experience.
- Corporate counsel, judges, and legal advisors with an interest in specializing in international arbitration.
- Current arbitrators seeking advanced certification to enhance their credentials and expertise.

PROGRAM FEES AND SCHOLARSHIPS

The CIMA Global Fellowship in International Arbitration offers a competitive fee structure, with discounts for CIMA members and early applicants. Partial Scholarships are also available for candidates from emerging economies, ensuring greater inclusivity and accessibility in line with CIMA's mission to democratize ADR education globally.

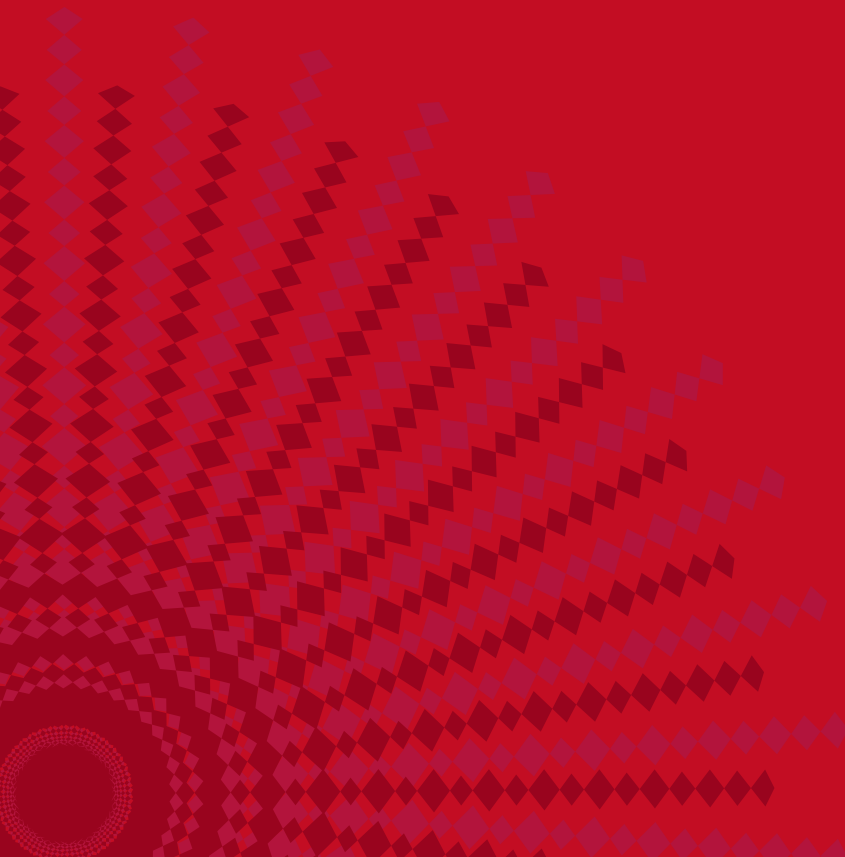
CONCLUSION

The CIMA World Fellowship in International Arbitration represents the pinnacle of professional certification for dispute resolution practitioners. Combining foundational principles with advanced strategic insight, the Fellowship prepares participants to excel in a complex, cross-border arbitration environment. Fellows emerge from the program equipped with the skills, knowledge, and ethical grounding to serve as trusted arbiters in any jurisdiction, reinforcing CIMA's commitment to elevating global standards in arbitration.

CIMA World Fellows Program

The CIMA World Fellows Program in International Mediation

The **CIMA World Fellows Program in International Mediation** is a prestigious and advanced certification program dedicated to cultivating world-class expertise in mediation. Designed for seasoned professionals and emerging leaders in the field, the program offers a comprehensive blend of theory, practice, and cross-cultural immersion, preparing participants to resolve complex disputes in diverse, high-stakes international settings. The Fellows Program is ideal for experienced mediators, legal practitioners, diplomats, business leaders, and conflict resolution experts who wish to deepen their mediation skills and gain a distinguished credential recognized worldwide.



The CIMA World Fellows Program in International Mediation is a rigorous, six-month course of study combining online learning modules, immersive in-person sessions, and case-based assessments. Taught by global experts in mediation, diplomacy, and conflict resolution, the program equips participants with advanced skills in negotiation, cross-cultural communication, and practical mediation strategies. Fellows engage in a unique learning experience that includes interactive case studies, mock mediation exercises, and real-world simulations, ensuring they are well-prepared to mediate complex, cross-border disputes.

PROGRAM OBJECTIVES

The CIMA World Fellows Program aims to:

- Build comprehensive knowledge of international mediation frameworks, principles, and best practices.
- Equip Fellows with specialized skills in mediating complex, multi-party disputes involving cross-cultural elements.
- Foster a global community of mediators who can collaborate on innovative approaches to conflict resolution.
- Prepare participants to handle sensitive, high-profile disputes and conflicts across industries and jurisdictions.



1. Foundations of International Mediation and Conflict Resolution

- Overview of the evolution and importance of mediation in global dispute resolution.
- Examination of international principles and frameworks that guide mediation practices, including the Singapore Convention on Mediation.
- Understanding mediation's role alongside other ADR methods in a multi-tiered dispute resolution system.

2. Advanced Mediation Techniques and Multi-Party Mediation

- Strategies for managing complex mediations involving multiple stakeholders, including governments, corporations, and NGOs.
- Techniques for facilitating constructive dialogue, managing high-stakes negotiations, and building consensus.
- Tools for managing power dynamics, entrenched positions, and conflict escalation in multi-party settings

3. Cross-Cultural Communication and Sensitivity in Mediation

- Key principles of cross-cultural communication and understanding cultural differences that impact mediation.
- Skills for building rapport, fostering mutual respect, and navigating cultural nuances in international disputes.
- Case studies illustrating the role of cultural awareness in successful mediation outcomes.

4. Mediation Ethics and Professional Standards

- Exploration of ethical standards and best practices for mediators, with a focus on confidentiality, impartiality, and neutrality.
- Addressing challenges related to conflicts of interest, disclosure, and mediator bias.
- Practical guidance on upholding ethics in complex and sensitive international mediations.



5. Technology in Mediation: e-Mediation, VR, and AI Applications

- Introduction to e-Mediation platforms and how technology is transforming the mediation process.
- Practical applications of Virtual Reality (VR) and Augmented Reality (AR) in mediation, including immersive environments and evidence presentation.
- Leveraging AI for case analysis, participant engagement, and enhancing procedural efficiency in mediation.

6. Specialized Mediation Practices and Sector-Focused Modules

- Industry-specific mediation strategies tailored to sectors such as commercial, environmental, construction, and family law disputes.
- Managing investor-state mediations, employment disputes, and public sector conflicts.
- Simulated sessions in which participants apply learned techniques to sector-focused case scenarios.

7. Capstone Project: Real-World Mediation Simulation

- Participants engage in a capstone project that involves a complex mediation simulation, applying their skills in a controlled but realistic environment.
- Scenarios are tailored to reflect cross-border, multi-party disputes with high stakes, requiring Fellows to employ their full range of skills.
- Feedback and guidance from CIMA's expert faculty, providing personalized insights for professional growth.

The CIMA World Fellows Program in International Mediation offers exclusive benefits that make it a standout credential in global ADR:

- **Mentorship and Networking:** Each Fellow is paired with a senior mediator mentor from CIMA's global network, offering career guidance, practical advice, and insights into complex mediation cases.
- **Global Alumni Network:** Graduates join an elite alumni community of CIMA Fellows, gaining access to international networking opportunities, collaborative projects, and regional forums.
- **Cross-Cultural Immersion Experience:** Participants have the option of attending an in-person immersion week in a major international city. This experience allows Fellows to engage with local and regional dispute resolution experts, further enhancing their cultural competence.

The program concludes with a rigorous assessment process, including a written examination, case study analysis, and the capstone mediation simulation. Fellows who successfully complete the program are awarded the **CIMA World Fellow in International Mediation** designation, recognized worldwide as a mark of distinction and expertise. This certification authorizes graduates to use the post-nominal “FCIMA” and entitles them to participate in exclusive CIMA initiatives and opportunities.

The World Fellows Program is open to experienced professionals with:

- A minimum of five years in mediation, legal practice, diplomacy, or conflict resolution.
- Strong references supporting their commitment to advancing mediation expertise.
- An interest in expanding their skills in cross-cultural and international dispute resolution.

PROGRAM FEES AND SCHOLARSHIPS

The CIMA World Fellows Program offers a competitive fee structure, with financial assistance options available for exceptional candidates from emerging economies. Scholarships are awarded based on merit and demonstrated financial need, aligning with CIMA's mission to support ADR capacity-building globally.

CONCLUSION

The CIMA World Fellows Program in International Mediation stands as the pinnacle of professional achievement in global dispute resolution. Graduates of this program join an esteemed cadre of mediators equipped to address the world's most challenging disputes with skill, integrity, and cultural sensitivity. Through a robust curriculum, practical experience, and global engagement, the CIMA World Fellowship empowers participants to make meaningful contributions to the field of mediation and to serve as trusted mediators in any jurisdiction.

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